

Beryllium

4
Be

While other metals expand when hot and contract when cold, beryllium keeps its shape at all temperatures. This means it can be used in machines such as high-speed aircraft, in which some parts may become extremely hot.

ATOMIC MASS 9.012

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1797
(Nicholas Louis Vauquelin)

Laboratory sample of
pure beryllium



Magnesium

12
Mg

Pure magnesium is added to other metals such as iron, not only to make them stronger but also more lightweight. Useful compounds of magnesium include magnesium carbonate, which is used in medicine for indigestion, and magnesium oxide, which is found in cement.

ATOMIC MASS 24.305

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1755
(Joseph Black)

Laboratory sample of
pure magnesium

